

MICHAEL KEUHLEN

keuhlen.michael@proton.me • linkedin.com/in/michaelkeuhlen • github.com/mkeuhlen

Professional Summary

Early-career cybersecurity professional with a decade of high-stakes public service experience in emergency response, including 911 dispatch, law enforcement, corrections, and emergency pre-hospital care. Recent BAS graduate in Cybersecurity with hands-on academic experience in pfSense, Suricata, Qualys VMDR, and other security tools. Passionate about applying my public safety background and technical skills in a service-oriented cybersecurity role where I can continue protecting communities while growing in the field.

RELEVANT PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Field Systems Technician (Tier 2 IT Support) | 08/2022 - 05/2025

H&R Block - Multi-State Region

- Supported 23 offices across 2 states as the primary on-site IT resource, troubleshooting hardware, software, and network incidents to maintain business continuity across a multi-state region.
- Deployed and maintained 23 local servers (Windows Server 2016), 23 dedicated backup systems, and ~200 multi-role Windows 10 and 11 workstations (POS, production, and third-party software systems), and 100+ various other networked peripherals like printers, point of sale card readers, etc.
- Coordinated with senior IT and vendor teams to escalate and resolve critical business impact issues requiring a coordinated response.
- Served as a member of the dispatch authorization team confirming documentation and troubleshooting accuracy; Performed the final review on escalated tickets before any field dispatch was approved, holding decisions to a 30-minute SLA from case creation for mission-critical tickets.
- Resolved 20 to 50+ field dispatch and tier 2 escalation tickets per day (volume driven by seasonal demand during peak tax season), routinely resolving cases remotely without field dispatch and significantly reducing unnecessary travel time for the company.
- Identified, contained, and escalated potential security incidents. Ex: Browser-based security threats (2 - 3 incidents annually), directing users through immediate device isolation via PXE boot, documenting scope of impact, and coordinating with infrastructure and security SMEs on remediation prior to reimage.

ACADEMIC SECURITY PROJECTS & EXPERIENCE

BCES Cybersecurity Awareness Training - Capstone Project | 03/2026 - 06/2026

- Partnering with Benton County Emergency Services (BCES) to design and deliver cybersecurity awareness training specifically tailored to 911 dispatch staff.
- Training addresses social engineering, phishing, and insider threats most likely to target 911 communications environments.
- Developed training content aligned to NIST and NENA best practices and adapted to real 911 PSAP operational workflows.
- Delivered training to 29 organizational staff in 4 classes over 2 days.
- Documented improvement after training of ~50% reduction in errors from line staff in training scenarios.

Academic Security Coursework & Portfolio - Columbia Basin College | 2022 - 2026

- Led a grey-box vulnerability assessment of a 21-device home network under a signed Rules of Engagement, using Nmap, Qualys VMDR, and inSSIDer alongside OSINT techniques (Shodan, WHOIS/ARIN, Have I Been Pwned) to identify and prioritize risks across wireless, IoT, and physical security controls.
- Authored a nine-document information security policy suite: Incident Response, Business Continuity, Disaster Recovery, Identity & Access Management, Mobile Device Security, Data Retention & Destruction, SDLC Security, Secure Coding, and Third-Party Library Usage.
- Completed applied labs in event log analysis, secure endpoint configuration, and web application session-hijacking exploitation using Burp Suite.
- Developed a Python-based password authentication tool, including analysis of hashing/salting weaknesses in the credential storage design.
- Coursework included dedicated study of cryptology, ethical hacking, penetration testing, wireless security, e-commerce security, and Unix/Linux administration.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Applied Science in Cybersecurity, cum laude | Columbia Basin College, 2026

CERTIFICATIONS

Qualys Vulnerability Management, Detection, and Response (VMDR) Specialist • 2026

CompTIA Security+ (SY0-701) • 2026

CompTIA A+ (1101/1102) • 2024

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Vulnerability & Threat Management: Qualys VMDR, Suricata IDS, pfBlockerNG, Burp Suite

Security Frameworks & Compliance: NIST SP 800 series, PCI DSS standards, CIS Controls, GRC policy drafting

Network Security: pfSense firewall configuration

Security Tools & Analysis: Wireshark, Nmap, inSSIDer, Packet and log analysis

Systems & Infrastructure: Windows 10/11 and Server 2016, Docker, Linux (CentOS), VMware, VirtualBox, Azure AD / Entra ID

Programming & Scripting: Python, SQL, and C++ academic foundational experience, Bash and PowerShell

ADDITIONAL EXPERIENCE - PUBLIC SAFETY & EMERGENCY RESPONSE

Emergency Communications Specialist - Aurora 911 | 10/2020 - 03/2022

Patrol Officer - Aurora Police Department | 02/2020 - 10/2020

Corrections and Custody Officer - Washington State DOC | 12/2013 - 02/2020

Emergency Medical Technician - Deer Park Ambulance | 04/2011 - 04/2013

AWARDS

Life Saving Award - City of Aurora | 2021

Eagle Scout - Boy Scouts of America | 2010